From NobleCount to the GPU

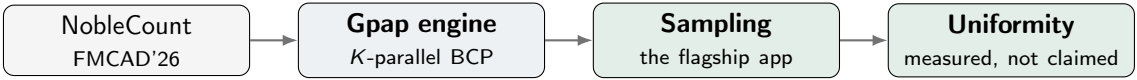
A K-parallel BCP primitive, and guaranteed-valid SAT solution sampling

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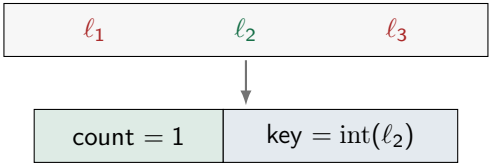
The story



The data structure is the thread: what removed clause scans from a CPU flip is what makes the GPU update race-free.

Where this starts: NobleCount (FMCAD'26)

a clause, one literal currently true



two fields per clause, updated branch-free on every flip

count $= 1 \Rightarrow$ the key **is** the surviving literal
$\Rightarrow$ **no clause scan, ever**

Dropped into ProbCCAnr, the SOTA local-search solver. **No heuristic changes, no re-tuning.**

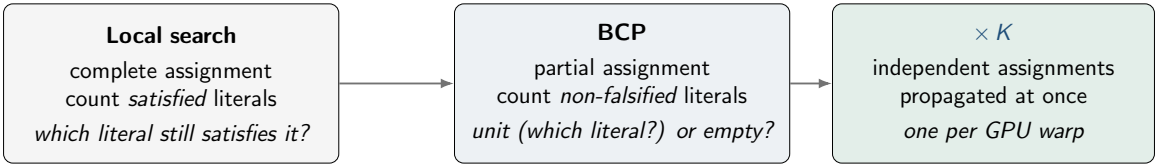
New state of the art on **FCC** (PAR2 -24.8%) *and* **SC22**.

A data-structure win, orthogonal to heuristic design.

Its own closing sentence

"... making it **a promising candidate for parallel clause-state maintenance in SIMD- or GPU-based implementations**."

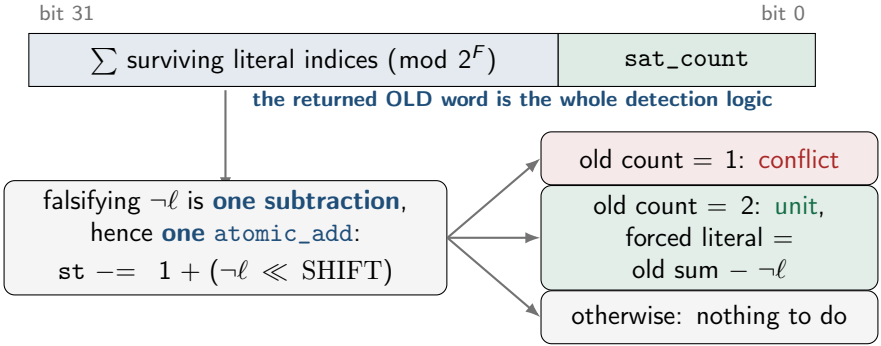
Same idea, different question



The primitive, in one line

Negated occurrence lists: setting ℓ true falsifies $\neg\ell$ in *exactly* the clauses of $\mathrm{occ}[\ell]$ — a decision touches only what it can affect.

One word per clause — and the update is its own detector



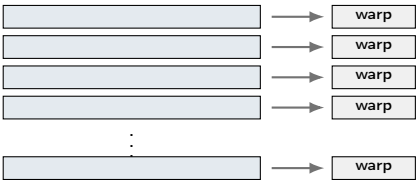
The **assignment** is the same trick: a bitmap where ℓ and $\neg\ell$ share a word, so one `atomic_or` returns duplicate *and* contradiction together.

On a CPU, XOR and sum are equivalent — NobleCount used XOR. On a GPU they are not: the sum makes the update an atomic whose *return value* resolves every race — no locks, no `shfl`/`ballot`.

The architecture: one assignment per warp

state: K independent rows

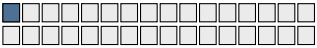
clause words (M) + assignment bits ($2N$)



a row is program-private

$\Rightarrow$ **no cross-row races**

SCALAR — small formulas, huge K



1 lane walks $\mathrm{occ}[\ell]$, 31 idle — no atomics needed: thousands of rows already saturate DRAM.

WAVE — large formulas, K-starved

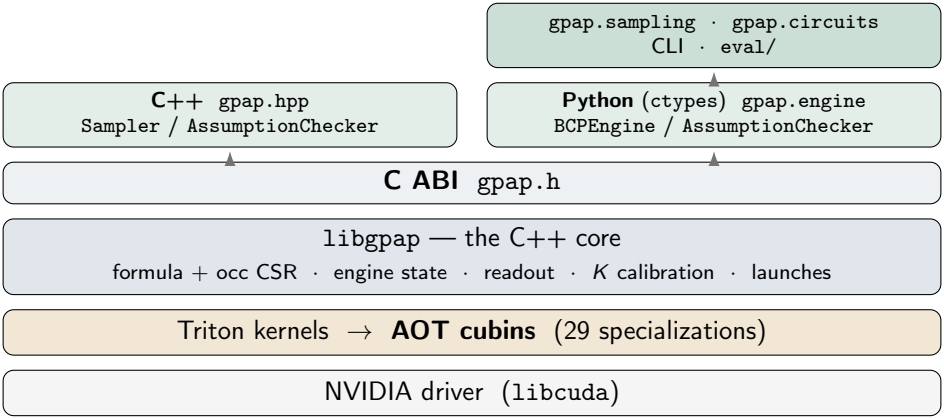


32 clause updates in flight *inside one assignment*; the atomics resolve the lane races.

Auto-dispatch: WAVE while $K < 30\times$ the GPU's resident warps, scalar beyond it

VRAM caps K at hundreds of rows on big formulas, so each row is latency-starved — that is what the extra lanes are for. Both variants share the state and give the same results.

The tool



One implementation: both faces link the same library, so there is no second engine to drift. The build needs no CUDA toolkit and no `nvcc`; the runtime needs `libcuda` alone.

The engine, in features

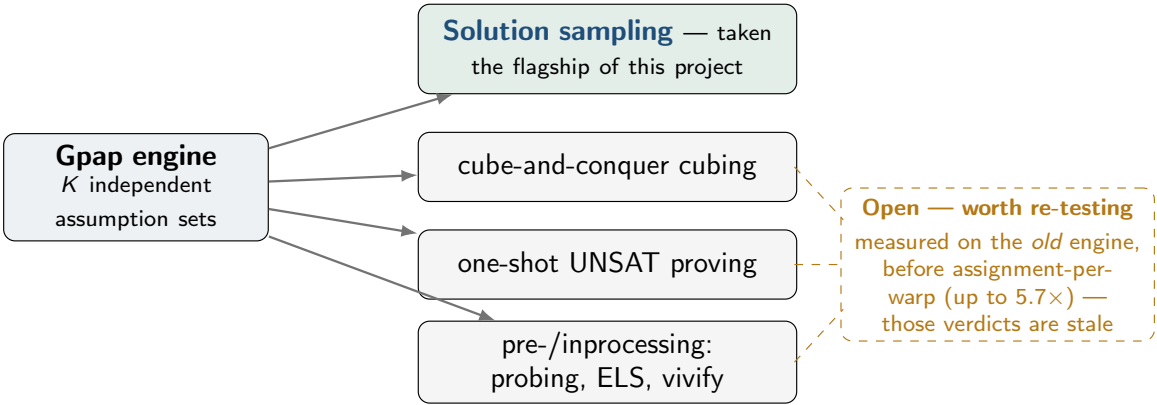
- one packed `int32` per clause — update is a single atomic
- assignment as a bitmap — one atomic gives dedup *and* contradiction
- two propagate kernels, **auto-dispatched** per formula
- the whole decide+propagate trajectory **fused into one launch**
- K sized analytically from free VRAM; unit-flush cached at construction
- readout stays **on device** — only counts and projections cross the bus
- two packed splits chosen per formula; out-of-envelope formulas rejected, never silently degraded

Bottom line

Up to 5.7× end-to-end over the pre-WAVE engine — with **bit-identical model sets** at every step.

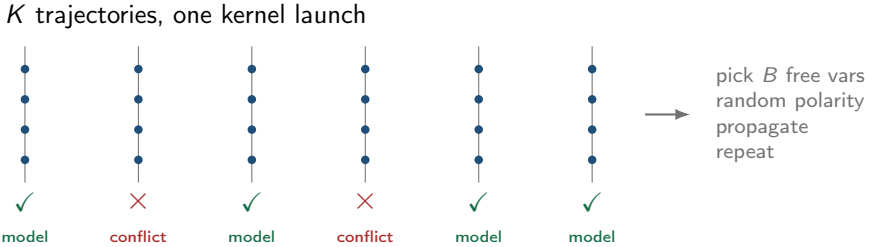
Negative results, kept because they cost weeks: classic **2-watched-literals on GPU is 1.8–2.6× slower** than NobleCount-style counting, on ∼5× the per-row state; 1-byte clause state, clause renumbering and multi-warp tiles all measured out.

What is a K-parallel BCP primitive good for?



Sampling fits the layout exactly: millions of independent randomized completions over one shared, read-only occurrence structure.

Gpap = GPU-parallel CMSGen



CMSGen's Algorithm 1, exactly — but K at a time on the GPU.

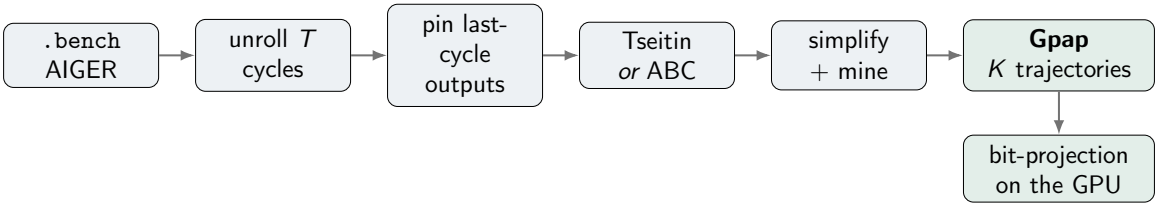
One structural difference: CMSGen backtracks; Gpap *discards*.

Two consequences

Every emitted row is a real model — no gradient, no rounding, no repair.

Discarding *is* rejection sampling $\Rightarrow$ an exactness knob (later).

The flagship pipeline

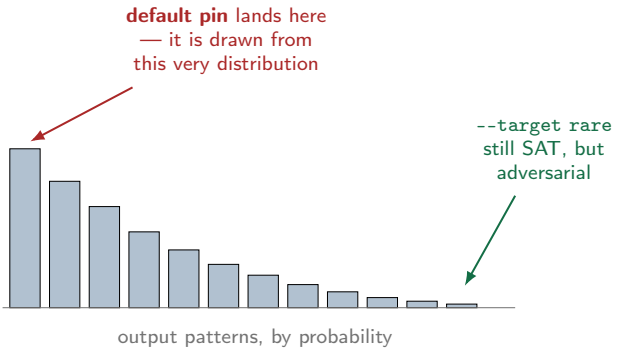


Support = primary inputs × cycles. Only the bit matrix leaves the device.

Encoder is a choice: native Tseitin, or ABC. Same projected solution set — gated by set-equality tests.

Config is per instance: a bandit measures at full K. The right answer is instance-dependent, so we never guess it.

The question we asked before a reviewer could: why not just simulate?



At default pins, CPU rejection beat us on 17/19 — so we changed the protocol, not the claim.

We use rejection, we do not just compete with it: it picks the targets, it audits every emitted sample, and at $B \geq |\text{support}|$ our sampler *is* rejection sampling.

And there are instances where it simply cannot play — EPFL at rare targets: 0 hits in ∼10M random patterns while Gpap holds 87k–64M samples/s at 89–100% success.

Also fixed before publishing: vacuous output pins (b02/b05/b07/s526 are constant at $T{=}25$), CMSGen timed *with* sample emission (5.3× its wall), and a GPU clock that swings 615–1710 MHz mid-run ⇒ interleaved A/Bs, 3-seed medians.

Headline: 357 rows, 13 stages, 0 errors

family	targets	GPAP / CMSGen	wins
ITC'99 + ISCAS-89 sequential, T=25	**rare**	36.5×	17/18
ITC'99 + ISCAS-89 sequential, T=25	random	105.8×	18/18
ISCAS-85 combinational	**rare**	538×	10/10
HWMCC'17 (curated), T=25	**rare**	156×	7/7
EPFL combinational	**rare**	12.7×	13/17
Sketch / `sk_` projected CNFs	—	48.5×	27/29

RTX 4080 laptop (`i7-13800H`) vs. single-core patched CMSGen; per instance at its best encoder. Rare targets cost ∼3× of the ratio versus rejection-easy random pins — **quote the rare column**.

Corrected 2026-08-04: the sequential rows now **exclude the vacuous-pin instances** (`b02/b05/b07/s526`, constant outputs at T=25). Including them read 47.7× / 107.9× — an inflation of up to 1.9× that fell almost entirely on the rare column. **The ratio also depends on the CPU**, because CMSGen is single-core: see the next frame but one.

The same suite on a datacenter GPU — and what actually moved

family	targets	4080 laptop	**Colab L4**	wins (L4)
ITC'99 + ISCAS-89 seq, T=25	**rare**	36.5×	39.1×	13/14
ISCAS-85 combinational	**rare**	538×	615×	10/10
HWMCC'17, T=25	**rare**	156×	196×	7/7
EPFL combinational	**rare**	12.7×	29.0×	13/16
Sketch / `sk_` CNFs	—	48.5×	113×	27/28

Every ratio went UP. None of it is Gpap.

Paired on identical cells: Gpap 0.96× (it is the *same* engine, on a slightly slower card) while **CMSGen runs at** 0.41× — a Xeon @ 2.2 GHz against an `i7-13800H`. CMSGen's own propagation *and* decision counters independently both give 0.413×.

So the rule: never quote a ratio without the CPU.

CMSGen is single-core, so this number is as much a property of the host as of the sampler. A datacenter comparison is fair *only* when reported this way — otherwise a reviewer reads 113× and correctly calls it a rigged baseline. The same caution applies in advance to the Technion cluster runs.

317 cells, 173 instance-slots, 0 skipped, 0 errors, 0 unsound. Sequential rows exclude the vacuous pins. Full per-family tables in the appendix.

Versus the GPU gradient samplers

rival	protocol	GPAP / rival	wins	rival failed
DEMOTIC (ASP-DAC'25)	*their* ISCAS-85 pins	2.5×	19/20	0
DEMOTIC	our **rare** pins	2,427×	18/18	0
Recurrent (MLCAD'25)	*their* target table	4.4×	6/6	3
Recurrent	our **rare** pins	635×	5/6	3
HTS (arXiv 2502.08673)	our CNFs, both encoders	1,584×	14/15	3

The protocol matters more than the rival. Recurrent-CircuitSAT — the closest rival to our domain — reads 4.4× on *their* pins and 635× on ours. A 140-fold swing, same sampler, same GPU, same day: only the target rarity changed.

Their pins are rejection-easy *by construction*, so winning there is not a sampling result — which is exactly why `--target rare` exists.

All three run on the *same* card, with *their* metric (uniques / their `model_runtime`, which excludes model build while ours includes construction). **rival failed** = timeout or no gradient path: reported, **never folded in as a zero**.

Honest losses: `75-10`, `prod-20`, the "service" family — jointly-constrained residuals needing clause *learning*, which gradient methods survive and we do not.

Does that verdict survive a different GPU?

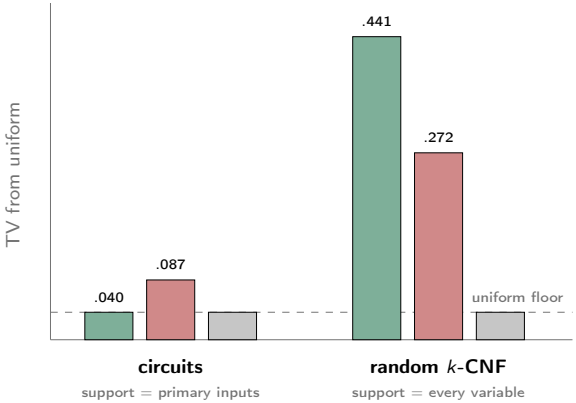
rival	protocol	GPAP / rival (geomean)		GPAP wins
		4080 laptop	**L4**	on L4
DEMOTIC	their ISCAS-85 pins	2.9×	2.5×	19/20
DEMOTIC	our **rare** pins	7,704×	2,427×	16/16
Recurrent	our **rare** pins	599×	422×	3/3
HTS	our CNFs, both encoders	—	2,042×	10/10

What transfers: the verdict. Win counts are *identical* on both cards instance by instance — the ranking is a property of the method, not the hardware. Both sides on the *same* card, *their* metric (uniques / their `model_runtime`, which excludes model build; ours includes construction).

What does not: the ratio magnitude. At rare pins the rival often scores ≈0, so the ratio is a near-zero denominator — and the rival gets *one* run where GPAP gets a 3-seed median. Their batch sizes were identical across the two cards, so the movement is run variance, not the GPU. Read those rows as orders of magnitude, never as a constant.

Geomeans cover the instances *both* cards scored (10/8/3/10). Honest: `c1355` loses on both (0.5×); at a rare `b11` pin *neither* sampler finds anything; 7 rival failures printed, never folded in as zeros. **CMSGen absent by design** — a CPU baseline needs cluster hardware.

Uniformity: measured against an exact oracle



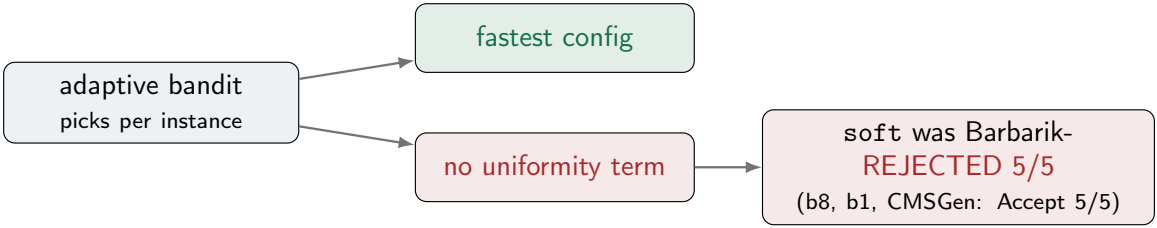
green = Gpap, red = CMSGen, grey = exact-uniform control.

The instrument: generate small formulas, enumerate their solutions exhaustively (solver-free), test χ^2 + TV against the *known* uniform. Calibrated: 0/120 false positives on an exact-uniform control, 97% power at TV 0.05. 600 instances, 10,800 runs, zero unsound rows.

On the flagship regime we are *at* the floor — and CMSGen is not. On random k-CNF we are worse. **Never quote the aggregate.**

An exactness knob: at $B \geq |\text{support}|$ one round fixes the whole support and we discard failures — exact rejection sampling, 24/24 at TV 0.0392. Bounded by yield when p_{accept} is small.

The uncomfortable one: our own bandit optimizes the wrong thing



Acted on: `soft` removed from the default portfolio, opt-in behind `--allow-soft`.

Nothing unsound — every row is a real solution — but a throughput bandit must not pick a rejected distribution for someone who asked for a *sampler*.

The price is large, and now measured TWICE:

- geomean 0.423× on the L4 (0.410× on the 4080) — the safe portfolio is ≈2.4× slower
- but `soft` only wins the bandit on **7/15**, so where it applies the loss is far larger: `b12` 10,864 → 23 samples/s
- `b11` is a capability loss: 276 → 0

Status, and what is open

Done

- engine: packed kernels, scalar + WAVE, `libgpap`, three language faces
- sampler: pipeline, portfolios, mining, ELS, GPU projection
- front-ends: `.bench`, AIGER, ABC, simulation
- evaluation: resumable sweep, 3-seed medians, fair CMSGen, 3 GPU rivals
- uniformity: 3-tier readout, Barbarik, exact-oracle fuzzing

Open — build

- **uniformity-aware config choice** — the one item that changes what a user gets
- per-instance encoder auto-pick
- state arena ($\sim$1.2$\times$)
- ROCm port (no kernel work)
- re-test the other applications

Open — measure

- **A100 rerun** — every number is K-bound on a 12 GB card
- multi-core CMSGen, QuickSampler
- break-even simulation throughput
- Barbarik $\times$10 / ScalBarbarik
- one single-session ablation

Turning this into a paper

A GPU-native clause-state primitive	one atomic's return value *is* the unit/conflict detection
A batched-assumption BCP engine	K independent assignments, one per warp + a measured dispatch rule
A sampler	guaranteed-valid; 12–538× over CMSGen, 10^2–10^5× over GPU rivals at rare targets
A measurement standard	rejection baseline, target rarity, vacuous pins, emission fairness, uniformity

Have: every figure on these slides, the 357-row sweep, three rival tables, the uniformity campaign.
Need: the A100 column, a multi-core CMSGen row, one single-session ablation, and a decision on the bandit/uniformity trade.

Backup: numbers on hand

Engine

- vs pre-WAVE: b14 5.7×, b12 2.8×, b04 1.8×, b03 1.5×
- rates: b03 631k, b06 945k, b04 81k, b12 50k, b14 4.0k attempts/s
- C++ port: 1.013× geomean, identical model sets
- portability: 75/1273 CUDA lines, 18 driver calls, 29/29 specializations cross-compile

Encoder

- ABC shrink 2.2–7.8× clauses; at rare targets bimodal (unlocks b14, collapses b13)
- `fast` vs `full`: b15 encode 99 s → $\leq$4 s

Uniformity

- 600 instances, 10,800 runs, 0 unsound; controls 0/600 FP, 600/600 power
- $B \geq |\mathrm{sup}|$: 24/24 ok, TV 0.0392 (theory floor 0.0399)
- circuits 0.040 vs CMSGen 0.087; CNF 0.441 vs 0.272
- `soft`: Reject 5/5 in 156–936 samples, TV median 0.694

Baselines / method

- CMSGen emission = 5.3× its wall (373 MB on 27.sk)
- rare-target amplification 500–500,000×
- SM clock 615–1710 MHz while >90% busy; draw noise ±40%

Appendix: every CMSGen family measured on the L4

family	targets	inst	GPAP/CMSGen	**no-vac**	wins	CMSGen 0
ITC'99 + ISCAS-89 seq, T=25	**rare**	19	58.2×	39.1×	17/18	1
ITC'99 + ISCAS-89 seq, T=50	**rare**	19	26.3×	14.0×	15/16	3
ITC'99 + ISCAS-89 seq, T=25	random	19	191.4×	183.3×	18/18	1
ITC'99 + ISCAS-89 seq, T=50	random	19	164.6×	147.0×	19/19	7
ISCAS-85 combinational	**rare**	10	615.4×	—	10/10	1
ISCAS-85 combinational	random	10	636.1×	—	10/10	1
HWMCC'17, T=25	**rare**	7	195.6×	—	7/7	5
HWMCC'17, T=50	**rare**	7	421.5×	—	7/7	6
HWMCC'17, T=25	random	7	263.8×	—	7/7	5
HWMCC'17, T=50	random	7	520.6×	—	7/7	6
EPFL combinational	**rare**	20	29.0×	—	13/16	1
EPFL combinational	random	20	19.5×	—	12/16	1
Sketch / `sk_` projected CNFs	—	29	113.1×	—	27/28	0

357 cells, 193 instance-slots, 0 skipped, 0 errors. GPU **NVIDIA L4**, CPU **Intel(R) Xeon(R) CPU @ 2.20GHz**. **no-vac** drops b02/b05/b07/s526, whose outputs are constant at T=25 so any sampler scores ∼100% — quote it, not the raw column. **CMSGen 0** counts instances where CMSGen emitted *zero* samples in budget: outright wins, but ratio = ∞, so they are EXCLUDED from every geomean above. The numbers are therefore conservative.

Appendix: every GPU rival measured on the L4

rival	protocol	cells	GPAP/rival	wins	rival failed
DEMOTIC	their ISCAS-85 pins	20	2.5×	19/20	0
DEMOTIC	our **rare** pins	18	2,426.6×	16/16	0
Recurrent	their target table	9	4.4×	6/6	3
Recurrent	our **rare** pins	9	634.9×	4/5	3
HTS	our CNFs (both encoders)	18	1,584.4×	11/12	3

Their metric: unique solutions / their `model_runtime`, which excludes their model build while ours includes construction. **rival failed** = timeout or no gradient path; those rows are reported, never folded in as a zero. Rows where the rival scored 0 are excluded from the geomean for the same reason as above.

Appendix: uniformity against an exact oracle

sampler	circuit		random k-CNF	
	median TV	skewed	median TV	skewed
`ctl:uniform`	0.0395	0/36	0.0401	0/36
`ctl:tv0.05`	0.0577	36/36	0.0580	36/36
`gpap:b1`	0.1109	18/36	0.4368	36/36
`gpap:b8`	0.0401	10/36	0.4033	36/36
`gpap:soft`	0.6255	24/36	0.7605	36/36
`gpap:b32`	0.0399	0/36	0.0401	0/36
`gpap:b64`	0.0399	0/36	0.0401	0/36
`cmsgen`	0.0945	25/36	0.2576	36/36

72 generated instances whose ENTIRE solution set is enumerated by brute force, so the target is known exactly; χ^2 over 3 seeds, Fisher-combined, $\alpha = 0.001$. 0 unsound emissions. **The controls calibrate the instrument**: `ctl:uniform` is exactly uniform and must NOT be flagged; `ctl:tv0.05` is skewed by a known amount and must be. `soft` is why it is opt-in — and $B \geq |\text{support}|$ (b32/b64) is exactly uniform, because discarding conflicts IS rejection sampling.